

SAILS ADVISORY

SAILS WORKING DOC · FOR REPS & FOUNDERS WHO SELL

The Objection Response Cards.

The twelve objections velocity reps hear most: what each one actually means, the isolate question, and the full talk track. One card per objection, built for the moment it happens.

6 PAGES · BY MATT WEISMAN

Every response is the same three moves.

Most objections aren't objections. They're unfinished sentences with a problem hiding inside. Arguing with the surface statement entrenches it; the pattern below finds the real cause and converts it into a next step.

The three moves

- **Acknowledge.** The concern is legitimate. "Fair enough" costs nothing and buys everything. Defensiveness confirms doubt.
- **Isolate.** Confirm it's the real and only blocker: "If we solved X, would you move forward?" Handling a fake objection brilliantly still loses.
- **Respond and advance.** Answer the isolated cause, then propose one specific, dated next step. A beautiful answer that ends with "so think it over" just scheduled the deal's funeral.

The five families

FAMILY	OBJECTIONS	ROOT CAUSE
Price	Too expensive · No budget · Competitor cheaper	Cost of the problem never established
Timing	Not a priority · Next quarter · Send me info	No trigger, or trigger lost to something louder
Status quo	Spreadsheet works · Already have a tool	Switching cost feels bigger than the pain
Trust	You're too small · Need to ask my boss	Risk of choosing wrong feels personal
Product	Missing feature · Doesn't integrate	Usually a proxy for a workflow worry

Remember: objection handling is 70% something you did or didn't do two calls ago. Reps who run a real qualification rubric hear fewer objections, because unqualified deals produce most of them.

The three money objections.

1 · "It's too expensive."

MEANS: expensive relative to a problem whose cost was never named. **ISOLATE:** "If the price were right, is this the tool you'd pick?"

"Fair enough. Can I ask: when we talked, you said missed follow-ups were costing you about two deals a month. What's a deal worth to you?"

2 · "We don't have budget."

MEANS: at velocity price points, budget is a decision, not a line item. **ISOLATE:** is this a no, or a not-like-this?

*"Totally understand. If budget weren't the issue, is this something you'd want running this quarter?"
(Yes: structure the start date or package. Hesitation: budget was never the real objection.)*

3 · "Your competitor is cheaper."

MEANS: they're price-anchoring, or genuinely comparing. Never argue the competitor's price. **ISOLATE:** what's driving the comparison?

"They might be the right call. The difference is [the one thing that maps to their trigger]. If that's not worth the gap, I'd honestly go with them." (Confidence sells. Defensiveness confirms doubt.)

The three delay objections.

4 · "This isn't a priority right now."

MEANS: the trigger resolved, or something bigger jumped the line. **ISOLATE:** which one?

"That's useful to know. When we first talked, [trigger] was the reason you took the call. Has that resolved, or has something bigger jumped the line?" (Resolved: nurture with a revisit date. Jumped: find out what's above it.)

5 · "Come back next quarter."

MEANS: usually a polite no; occasionally a real budget cycle. **ISOLATE:** ask for something small now.

"Happy to. So next quarter's conversation is fast: would you be open to a 20-minute pilot scoping call now, so you can start day one of the quarter?" (Yes: it's real. No: nurture, stop spending touches.)

6 · "Send me more info."

MEANS: the classic stall. Never just send the deck. **ISOLATE:** what would the info need to answer?

"Happy to. To make sure I send the right thing: what specifically would help you make a decision?" (Or trade the send for a booked follow-up: "I'll send it today. Can we grab 15 minutes Thursday so I can answer whatever it raises?")

Inertia and risk.

7 · "The spreadsheet works fine."

MEANS: it does, for the part of the job they can see. **ISOLATE:** make the invisible cost visible, in question form.

"For tracking, spreadsheets are honestly fine. Where teams get burned is the part the spreadsheet doesn't do: who followed up, who didn't, what fell through. How do you catch that today?"

8 · "We already have a tool for that."

MEANS: if the tool worked, they wouldn't be on the call. **ISOLATE:** find the gap that produced the meeting.

"Makes sense. What made you take this call anyway?" (That answer is the entire deal. Sell to it and nothing else.)

9 · "You're too small / too new."

MEANS: the risk of choosing wrong feels personal. Structure beats reassurance. **ISOLATE:** what would make the risk acceptable?

"Fair concern. That's why the first 30 days are structured as [pilot / month-to-month / onboarding milestones], so the decision you're making today is small, and the big decision happens after you've seen it work."

10 · "I need to talk to my partner / boss."

MEANS: sometimes true, always a threat to deal control. **ISOLATE:** get into that conversation.

"Of course. What do you think their main question will be? Would it be easier if the three of us took 15 minutes so they hear it straight?"

The two capability objections.

11 · "You're missing feature X."

MEANS: half the time it's a wish, not a dealbreaker. **ISOLATE:** day one or roadmap?

"Got it. Is X something you need on day one, or something you'd want on the roadmap? And what's the job you'd use it for?" (Half the time the job is doable another way. The other half: be honest, log it, and decide whether to sell around it or walk.)

12 · "It doesn't integrate with Y."

MEANS: the worry underneath is double data entry. Answer the worry, not the API question. **ISOLATE:** what needs to flow?

"What would you need flowing between the two systems?" (Then show the actual workflow: export, Zapier, native, or manual-but-five-minutes. If it truly breaks their operation, disqualify honestly; it beats a churn in month three.)

Book a Discovery Call

If the same objection keeps killing deals across the whole team, that's not a rep problem: it's positioning or qualification upstream. The SAILS engagement finds which one, then fixes the playbook so the objection stops arriving. 30 minutes, no deck.

calendar.app.google/x2MYasUSFXEeow459